

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 22

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor those individuals, organizations, and agencies that came to the aid of their fellow citizens during Hurricane Helene.

WHEREAS, on September 27, 2024, one of the most catastrophic floods ever to hit this State devastated several areas across East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, on that fateful day, the water rose rapidly across East Tennessee as torrential rains fell, causing extensive damage in Carter, Cocke, Grainger, Greene, Hamblen, Hawkins, Jefferson, Johnson, Sevier, Sullivan, Unicoi, and Washington counties; and

WHEREAS, these portions of East Tennessee suffered catastrophic flooding, with vast swaths of communities washed away in the flood waters, and seventeen individuals were confirmed to have lost their lives due to the rampaging water that reached an unprecedented level; and

WHEREAS, without hesitation or concern for their own safety, citizens, community organizations, and government agencies quickly stepped up and united with area first responders and emergency personnel to help their fellow Tennesseans in distress, selflessly making countless heroic efforts to rescue their neighbors from the flood waters; and

WHEREAS, as the good people of East Tennessee and the surrounding areas begin to recover from this catastrophe, they are filled with gratitude for the many who risked their lives to prevent further damage and to save those in danger; and

WHEREAS, they are grateful for and overwhelmed by the humanitarian efforts of the many businesses, charitable and civic organizations, churches, government agencies, and individuals who responded promptly and gave generously of their resources to help the people of East Tennessee in their time of dire need; and

WHEREAS, local and State agencies involved in recovery efforts include the Department of Commerce and Insurance, the Department of Environment and Conservation, the Department of Health, the Department of Human Services, the Department of Labor and Workforce Development, the Department of Military, the Department of Revenue, the Department of Safety and Homeland Security, the Department of Transportation, Governor Bill Lee and the Governor's offices, individual State employees, members of the General Assembly, the Office of the First Lady, TennCare, the Tennessee Emergency Management Agency, the Tennessee Highway Patrol, and countless other individuals and volunteers; and

WHEREAS, it has been said that the human race is at its best when circumstances are at their worst; this adage is proven by the generous and compassionate manner in which the citizens of this great State and nation opened their hearts to the people of East Tennessee with emergency and medical assistance, moral and financial support, and, most importantly, love and understanding during the recent flooding disaster; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commend and offer our appreciation and most sincere thanks to all the first responders; firefighters; healthcare personnel; law enforcement officers; missionary groups and churches; animal rescue groups; local, state, and federal agencies; and corporations, individuals, businesses, organizations, and agencies that provided professional assistance or humanitarian aid to the citizens of East Tennessee during the recent flood that raged through the communities and surrounding areas. We extend our deepest appreciation to those heroic, everyday Tennesseans, who, in a moment of great peril, came to the aid and rescue of their neighbors and friends without hesitation; it is these unsung heroes who comprise the very heart of the Volunteer State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.